

Employee Handbook

Version 3.2

Owner: Sarah Chen

Department: Human Resources

Internal document. Readable by all employees.

§1.1 — Purpose and Scope

This handbook describes the terms, expectations, and benefits that apply to all full-time employees of Acme Corporation. It supersedes all previous editions and should be read alongside the department-specific policies published by Human Resources, Legal, and Operations.

Where this handbook conflicts with a signed employment agreement, the employment agreement prevails. Where it conflicts with another internal policy, employees should raise the discrepancy with their manager or with Human Resources rather than assuming either source is correct.

§7.1 — Leave Overview

Acme Corporation provides several categories of leave: casual leave, paid time off, sick leave, parental leave, and unpaid personal leave. Entitlements are calculated on a calendar-year basis beginning 1 January.

Employees joining part-way through a year accrue leave on a pro-rata basis, rounded up to the nearest half day. Leave balances are visible in the employee self-service portal and are updated overnight.

§7.2 — Public Holidays

Acme Corporation observes twelve public holidays per calendar year. The published holiday calendar is issued each November for the following year. Employees required to work on a public holiday are entitled to compensatory time off, to be taken within ninety days.

§7.3 — Casual Leave

All full-time employees are entitled to ten (10) days of casual leave per calendar year, subject to manager approval and standard carry-forward rules.

Casual leave is intended for short, unplanned absences such as personal errands, family obligations, or brief illness not requiring medical certification. Requests of three or more consecutive days should be submitted at least one week in advance where circumstances allow.

Unused casual leave may be carried forward to the following calendar year up to a maximum of five days. Any balance beyond that lapses on 31 December and is not paid out on termination.

§7.4 — Paid Time Off

Full-time employees accrue 15 days of PTO per year during their first three years of employment, increasing to 20 days after the third anniversary.

Paid time off is distinct from casual leave and is intended for planned vacation. PTO requests should be submitted through the self-service portal at least two weeks in advance, and are approved subject to team coverage requirements.

§8.1 — Performance Reviews

Formal performance evaluations are conducted annually during Q4. Mid-year check-ins are encouraged but not mandatory.

The annual review considers objectives agreed at the start of the cycle, peer feedback, and the employee's own self-assessment. Outcomes inform compensation review, which is processed separately in Q1 of the following year.

§12.4 — Termination Procedures

All company property, including laptops, access badges, and peripherals, must be returned within five (5) business days of the last working day.

The employee's manager is responsible for confirming return of all issued items and notifying IT Operations so that system access can be revoked. Final settlement of salary and unused entitlements is processed in the payroll cycle following confirmation of asset return.